

Core Endpoints

Tavily Search

 Copy page

Execute a search query using Tavily Search.

POST / search

JavaScript SDK

JS JavaScript 

```
const { tavily } = require("@tavily/core");

const tvly = tavily({ apiKey: "tvly-YOUR_API_KEY" });
const response = await tvly.search("Who is Leo Messi?");

console.log(response);
```

```
"images": [],
"results": [
  {
    "title": "Lionel Messi Facts | Britannica",
    "url": "https://www.britannica.com/facts/Lionel-Messi",
    "content": "Lionel Messi, an Argentine footballer, is widely regarded as one of the g",
    "score": 0.81025416,
    "raw_content": null,
    "favicon": "https://britannica.com/favicon.png",
    "images": [
      {
        "url": "<string>",
        "description": "<string>"
      }
    ]
  }
],
"response_time": "1.67",
"auto_parameters": {
  "topic": "general",
  "search_depth": "basic"
},
"usage": {
  "credits": 1
},
"request_id": "123e4567-e89b-12d3-a456-426614174111"
}
```

Authorizations

Authorization string header required

Bearer authentication header in the form Bearer , where is your Tavily API key (e.g., Bearer tvly-YOUR_API_KEY).

Body

application/json

Example: "who is Leo Messi?"

`search_depth` `enum<string>` `default:basic`

Controls the latency vs. relevance tradeoff and how `results[].content` is generated:

- `advanced` : Highest relevance with increased latency. Best for detailed, high-precision queries. Returns multiple semantically relevant snippets per URL (configurable via `chunks_per_source`).
- `basic` : A balanced option for relevance and latency. Ideal for general-purpose searches. Returns one NLP summary per URL.
- `fast` : Prioritizes lower latency while maintaining good relevance. Returns multiple semantically relevant snippets per URL (configurable via `chunks_per_source`).
- `ultra-fast` : Minimizes latency above all else. Best for time-critical use cases. Returns one NLP summary per URL.

Cost:

- `basic` , `fast` , `ultra-fast` : 1 API Credit
- `advanced` : 2 API Credits

See [Search Best Practices](#) for guidance on choosing the right search depth.

Available options: `advanced` , `basic` , `fast` , `ultra-fast`

`chunks_per_source` `integer` `default:3`

Chunks are short content snippets (maximum 500 characters each) pulled directly from the source. Use `chunks_per_source` to define the maximum number of relevant chunks returned per source and to control the `content` length. Chunks will appear in the `content` field as: `<chunk 1> [...] <chunk 2> [...]` `<chunk 3>` . Available only when `search_depth` is `advanced` .

Required range: `1 <= x <= 3`

Required range: $0 \leq x \leq 20$

Example: 1

`topic` `enum<string>` `default:general`

The category of the search. `news` is useful for retrieving real-time updates, particularly about politics, sports, and major current events covered by mainstream media sources. `general` is for broader, more general-purpose searches that may include a wide range of sources.

Available options: `general` , `news` , `finance`

`time_range` `enum<string>`

The time range back from the current date to filter results based on publish date or last updated date. Useful when looking for sources that have published or updated data.

Available options: `day` , `week` , `month` , `year` , `d` , `w` , `m` , `y`

`start_date` `string`

Will return all results after the specified start date based on publish date or last updated date. Required to be written in the format YYYY-MM-DD

Example: "2025-02-09"

`end_date` `string`

Will return all results before the specified end date based on publish date or last updated date. Required to be written in the format YYYY-MM-DD

Example: "2025-12-29"

`include_raw_content` `boolean` `default:false`

Include the cleaned and parsed HTML content of each search result. `markdown` or `true` returns search result content in markdown format. `text` returns the plain text from the results and may increase latency.

`include_images` `boolean` `default:false`

Include images in the response. Returns both a top-level `images` list of query-related images and an `images` array inside each result object with images extracted from that specific source.

`include_image_descriptions` `boolean` `default:false`

When `include_images` is `true`, also add a descriptive text for each image.

`include_favicon` `boolean` `default:false`

Whether to include the favicon URL for each result.

`include_domains` `string[]`

A list of domains to specifically include in the search results. Maximum 300 domains.

`exclude_domains` `string[]`

A list of domains to specifically exclude from the search results. Maximum 150 domains.

Available options: afghanistan , albania , algeria , andorra , angola , argentina , armenia , australia , austria , azerbaijan , bahamas , bahrain , bangladesh , barbados , belarus , belgium , belize , benin , bhutan , bolivia , bosnia and herzegovina , botswana , brazil , brunei , bulgaria , burkina faso , burundi , cambodia , cameroon , canada , cape verde , central african republic , chad , chile , china , colombia , comoros , congo , costa rica , croatia , cuba , cyprus , czech republic , denmark , djibouti , dominican republic , ecuador , egypt , el salvador , equatorial guinea , eritrea , estonia , ethiopia , fiji , finland , france , gabon , gambia , georgia , germany , ghana , greece , guatemala , guinea , haiti , honduras , hungary , iceland , india , indonesia , iran , iraq , ireland , israel , italy , jamaica , japan , jordan , kazakhstan , kenya , kuwait , kyrgyzstan , latvia , lebanon , lesotho , liberia , libya , liechtenstein , lithuania , luxembourg , madagascar , malawi , malaysia , maldives , mali , malta , mauritania , mauritius , mexico , moldova , monaco , mongolia , montenegro , morocco , mozambique , myanmar , namibia , nepal , netherlands , new zealand , nicaragua , niger , nigeria , north korea , north macedonia , norway , oman , pakistan , panama , papua new guinea , paraguay , peru , philippines , poland , portugal , qatar , romania , russia , rwanda , saudi arabia , senegal , serbia , singapore , slovakia , slovenia , somalia , south africa , south korea , south sudan , spain , sri lanka , sudan , sweden , switzerland , syria , taiwan , tajikistan , tanzania , thailand , togo , trinidad and tobago , tunisia , turkey , turkmenistan , uganda , ukraine , united arab emirates , united kingdom , united states , uruguay , uzbekistan , venezuela , vietnam , yemen , zambia , zimbabwe

`auto_parameters` `boolean` `default:false`

When `auto_parameters` is enabled, Tavily automatically configures search parameters based on your query's content and intent. You can still set other parameters manually, and your explicit values will override the automatic ones. The parameters `include_answer` , `include_raw_content` , and `max_results` must always be set manually, as they directly affect response size. Note: `search_depth` may be automatically set to `advanced` when it's likely to improve results. This uses 2 API credits per request. To avoid the extra cost, you can explicitly set `search_depth` to `basic` .

>

Smith" CEO Acme Corp). Punctuation is typically ignored inside quotes.

include_usage boolean default:false

Whether to include credit usage information in the response.

safe_search boolean default:false

 Enterprise only.

whether to filter out adult or unsafe content from results. Not supported for `fast` or `ultra-fast` search depths.

Response

200 

application/json

Search results returned successfully

query string required

The search query that was executed.

Example: "Who is Leo Messi?"

Example: "Lionel Messi, born in 1987, is an Argentine footballer widely regarded as one of the greatest players of his generation. He spent the majority of his career playing for FC Barcelona, where he won numerous domestic league titles and UEFA Champions League titles. Messi is known for his exceptional dribbling skills, vision, and goal-scoring ability. He has won multiple FIFA Ballon d'Or awards, numerous La Liga titles with Barcelona, and holds the record for most goals scored in a calendar year. In 2014, he led Argentina to the World Cup final, and in 2015, he helped Barcelona capture another treble. Despite turning 36 in June, Messi remains highly influential in the sport."

images `object[]` **required**

A list of query-related images from image search. If `include_image_descriptions` is true, each item will have `url` and `description`. Note: per-result images are also returned inside each result object's `images` field.

Show child attributes

Example:

[]

results `object[]` **required**

A list of sorted search results, ranked by relevancy.

Show child attributes

>

Example: "1.67"

auto_parameters `object`

A dictionary of the selected auto_parameters, only shown when `auto_parameters` is true.

Example:

```
{  
  "topic": "general",  
  "search_depth": "basic"  
}
```

usage `object`

Credit usage details for the request.

Example:

```
{ "credits": 1 }
```

request_id `string`

A unique request identifier you can share with customer support to help resolve issues with specific requests.

Example: "123e4567-e89b-12d3-a456-426614174111"



Resources

About

Tavily Search Crawler

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